

HOUSE JOINT RESOLUTION 1142

By Salinas

A RESOLUTION to honor native Tennessean Valerie June for her many and diverse talents and her exemplary career in music.

WHEREAS, music has long been an integral part of Tennessee's rich cultural heritage, inspiring audiences around the world; and

WHEREAS, it is fitting that the members of this General Assembly should recognize those gifted musical artists whose dedication to their craft brings distinction to themselves and to this State; and

WHEREAS, one such exceptional artist is Valerie June Hockett, a self-described ambassador for joy via her music; and

WHEREAS, Valerie June is a Grammy-nominated songwriter, singer, multi-instrumentalist, recording artist, and author; her music is influenced by many genres, including psychedelic folk, indie rock, Appalachian, bluegrass, country soul, symphonic pop, and blues, and reflects both her Southern roots and East Coast experiences; and

WHEREAS, a native Tennessean, Valerie June Hockett was born in Jackson and grew up in Humboldt, where she was exposed to gospel music at her local church and rhythm and blues and soul music by her father, Emerson Hockett; and

WHEREAS, as a teenager, Valerie June first worked for her father at his construction company and later served as a part-time promoter for gospel singers and pop artists such as Prince, K-Ci & JoJo, and Bobby Womack; and

WHEREAS, at the age of nineteen, Valerie June began recording and performing as a member of the duo Bella Sun; and

WHEREAS, relocating to Memphis in 2000, Valerie June began her career as a solo artist, combining blues, gospel, and Appalachian folk music into a style that she describes as

"organic moonshine roots music"; she also learned to play guitar, banjo, and lap-steel guitar and became associated with the Memphis-based Broken String Collective; and

WHEREAS, Valerie June self-released three albums before recording her debut album as a signed artist, 2013's *Pushin' Against a Stone*, which was nominated in the Best New Artist Debut category at the Blues Music Awards; the album's musical quality and popular appeal led to her making an appearance on *Austin City Limits*; and

WHEREAS, following the success of her debut studio album, Valerie June released *The Order of Time* in 2017 and *The Moon and the Stars: Prescriptions for Dreamers* in 2021, both of which earned critical acclaim; and

WHEREAS, Valerie June's "Call Me a Fool" was nominated as the Grammy's Best American Roots Song in 2021; and

WHEREAS, in 2025, Valerie June released her most recent album, *Owls, Omens and Oracles*, which has been praised as an "album, full of melody, soul, and inspired songwriting"; and

WHEREAS, for more than a decade, Valerie June has played live shows worldwide, notably opening for The Rolling Stones in London and sharing the stage and performing with artists such as Willie Nelson, Neil Young, Jack Johnson, Brandi Carlile, Sturgill Simpson, Gary Clark, Jr., John Prine, and Tyler Childers; and

WHEREAS, this multi-talented creator is also the author of three published books: *Maps for the Modern World*, *Somebody to Love: The Story of Valerie June's Sweet Little Baby Banjolele*, and *Light Beams: A Workbook for Being Your Badass Self*; and

WHEREAS, Valerie June's remarkable success as a singer, songwriter, musician, and author stands as a testament to her perseverance, talent, and unwavering dedication to her art, and she is most worthy of our approbation; now, therefore,

BE IT RESOLVED BY THE HOUSE OF REPRESENTATIVES OF THE ONE HUNDRED FOURTEENTH GENERAL ASSEMBLY OF THE STATE OF TENNESSEE, THE SENATE CONCURRING, that we honor native Tennessean Valerie June for her many and diverse talents and her exemplary career in music, expressing the State of Tennessee's pride in her accomplishments and wishing her all the best in her future endeavors.

BE IT FURTHER RESOLVED, that an appropriate copy of this resolution be prepared for presentation with this final clause omitted from such copy and upon proper request made to the appropriate clerk, the language appearing immediately following the State seal appear without House or Senate designation.